Sabakiball: Pivoting to Global Expansion

Economic Model

1. Executive Overview

Sabakiball is a patented, standardized sport with over 1,000,000 participants and adoption across 300+ U.S. and Canadian schools, as well as programs in ten countries and five continents.

This is an acquisition of a fully developed sport + IP package, supported by a simple equipment system and a predictable replacement cycle.

A strategic buyer with existing distribution can scale Sabakiball nationally by plugging the sport into their established school channels, youth networks, or recreational programs.

2. Investment Thesis

Acquire a defensible, patent-protected team sport that combines a unique goal structure (back-stop + knock-down pin) with a codified rule set (mandatory passing, time-limited possession, penalty system).

The opportunity is to turn this IP into the next "Spikeball / Pickleball-style" category: a portable, social, easy-to-teach game for schools, rec leagues, and backyards.

Global sports equipment is a ~$110–115B market in 2024 and growing ~6–8% annually. (Fact.MR)

Niche sports can scale quickly: standalone equipment markets for Spikeball and Pickleball are already measured in the hundreds of millions to low billions of dollars. (Market.us).

This acquisition is a way to option a new category early while the key method-of-play and apparatus IP is still in force.

3. Product & Equipment Economics

Sabakiball's value is anchored in a simple, durable, long-life equipment system:

Core Components

- Patented backboard
- Patented pin system
- Official Sabakiballs (primary recurring item)
- Cones, markers, and basic accessories
- Standardized gameplay & ruleset

Durability

- Backboards typically last 10–15 years
- Pins last several years

- Balls are the main replacement item due to high usage and wear

Economic Meaning

- One-time equipment installation creates a long-term recurring relationship with consistent yearly activity
- Schools remain customers for more than a decade
- Consumables (balls) generate natural recurring demand

Potential Revenue Streams

- Equipment sales
  - Back-stop + base + goal pin + balls sold as a complete kit (Starter vs Pro)
- Replacement & accessories
  - Extra pins, balls, branded apparel, referee kits, coaching packs
  - High-margin add-ons once a league or school is locked in
- IP & League licensing
  - Licensing the rule set + brand + logo + court markings to:
    - School districts and PE curriculum
    - Municipal rec leagues & YMCA-type organizations
    - Private facilities / franchise models
- Media & sponsorship (longer-term)
  - Naming rights on back-stops, jersey sponsors, streaming rights for tournaments once a competitive circuit is built

Upside vs comps:
If this game achieves even 20–30% of the scale that Spikeball and Pickleball have reached in equipment sales, a $30M+ revenue run-rate and high teens/20s EBITDA margin is realistic. (Market.us)

The equipment system is low-SKU, easy to manufacture, simple to distribute, and ideal for companies already serving schools or recreation programs.

4. Market Size & Adoption Base

In 2023, team sports participation in the U.S. reached 70.8M people, the highest level in a decade, with ~8M more participants than 2022. (Sports and Fitness Industry Association)

Globally, "participatory sports" (people playing, not just watching) is a $300B+ market and still growing. (The Business Research Company)

Proof from comps – new sports scale fast:

- Spikeball equipment is already a $150M+ market in 2024, projected to roughly double by the early 2030s. (Market.us)

- Pickleball equipment/apparel is around $1.6–2.5B and projected to more than double by 2030–2032. (The Dink Pickleball)

Current Adoption:

- 300+ schools
- 1,000,000+ lifetime participants
- Played in 5 continents
- Strongest presence: U.S. & Canada

Market Potential:

- 24,000+ middle and high schools in the U.S.
- Current penetration is ~1.25%
- Even modest expansion (5–10%) represents significant scale for an acquirer

Why Adoption Is Sticky:

- Fits easily into PE curriculum
- Affordable (typically under $5,000 to outfit a full school)
- Non-contact, safe, and inclusive
- Supports large class sizes
- Can be taught via app, minimal training load

Key Risks & Mitigants

Adoption risk (will people play it?)
Mitigant: Start with schools & PE (trial run), then grow youth leagues and social rec play—exactly how many emerging sports have scaled. Use turnkey "sport-in-a-box" kits for PE teachers and rec directors.

Copycat products once patents expire
Mitigant: Build brand, community, and organized leagues around the game so that "official" equipment and rules remain preferred, even after IP expiry—just as with other mature sports.

Execution & marketing risk
Mitigant: This is precisely where a strategic acquirer with an existing salesforce, influencer relationships, and retail footprint can create disproportionate value compared with a stand-alone inventor.

Schools rotate Sabakiball annually, so each kit supports new participants every year without needing full replacement.

5. Customer Adoption Model

How Schools Adopt:

- Awareness via teacher networks, nonprofit channels, or word-of-mouth
- School purchases a starter kit
- Teachers learn the sport using the app
- Students pick up gameplay quickly
- Sport becomes part of annual PE rotation
- Balls (and occasionally pins) replaced as needed

Economic Implication:

Once adopted, Sabakiball becomes:

- Part of the annual PE routine
- A multi-year recurring equipment relationship
- A “sticky” sport that rarely gets discontinued

This creates long-term value without the need for subscriptions or high-touch customer service.

6. IP Protection & Defensibility

Sabakiball is protected by a broad, enforceable patent covering:

- Equipment design
- Scoring method
- Gameplay mechanics
- Ruleset

This gives the acquirer:

- Complete exclusivity over the official equipment
- Monopolistic control of the sport category
- Ability to own downstream opportunities (leagues, certifications, licensing)
- A durable barrier to entry

IP protection is the central driver of strategic value.

7. Digital Layer: The Sabakiball App

The pre-mature mobile training app serves as:

- A teacher onboarding tool
- A drill and rules explanation platform
- A scalable training system that reduces labor cost
- A potential base for future certification or curriculum content
- A digital exposure engine that introduces kids to the field layout, positions, gameplay, and rules

This digital layer:

- Creates early interest and desire to play physically
- Lowers friction to learning and adoption
- Acts as a funnel where digital play drives real-world participation

Overall, the app removes onboarding friction, accelerates awareness, and allows the sport to scale with minimal intervention by the acquirer.

8. Multi-Segment Reach

Sabakiball is already used beyond schools. Each segment has its own economic path:

- Youth & Community Organizations
- Senior & Active Adult Communities
- International Schools
- Leagues

The sport's simplicity and low cost make it adaptable across all segments.

9. Cost & Adoption Advantage

Compared to traditional school sports:

- Hockey ($50k–100k)
- Football ($30k–80k)
- Soccer ($15k–30k)
- Basketball ($5k–20k)

Sabakiball can launch a full school program for under $5,000.

Illustrative TAM (U.S. only):

- 1% of ~70M participants → 700k players
- ~70k–90k active equipment sets

This affordability translates into:

- Faster initial adoption
- Easier district-wide rollout
- High accessibility for budget-constrained schools

10. Strategic Rationale for Acquisition

An acquirer gains:

- A complete, proven sport, not a concept
- A patent that ensures exclusivity
- A large, validated adoption base
- A durable equipment model with recurring demand
- A digital platform that accelerates scaling
- A multi-segment growth roadmap

Strategic Benefits:

- Category creation
- Cross-sell & bundle opportunities
- Portfolio diversification

11. Investment Conclusion

Sabakiball is a unique opportunity to acquire a patent-protected sport that already has real traction and room to grow. With a recurring revenue model, solid unit economics, and clear paths to expand through schools and recreational networks, it has the potential to become a new category. A strategic buyer with the right distribution could scale adoption and build a broader ecosystem around the sport.